

Isaiah 40:31

But they that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint.

Verses 30 and 31 are one sentence.

Isaiah 40:30-31

Even the youths shall faint and be weary, and the young men shall utterly fall: [31] But they that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint.

Verses 12-31 are all one topic

Isaiah 40:12-31

Who hath measured the waters in the hollow of his hand, and meted out heaven with the span, and comprehended the dust of the earth in a measure, and weighed the mountains in scales, and the hills in a balance? [13] Who hath directed the Spirit of the LORD, or being his counsellor hath taught him? [14] With whom took he counsel, and who instructed him, and taught him in the path of judgment, and taught him knowledge, and shewed to him the way of understanding? [15] Behold, the nations are as a drop of a bucket, and are counted as the small dust of the balance: behold, he taketh up the isles as a very little thing. [16] And Lebanon is not sufficient to burn, nor the beasts thereof sufficient for a burnt offering. [17] All nations before him are as nothing; and they are counted to him less than nothing, and vanity. [18] To whom then will ye liken God? or what likeness will ye compare unto him? [19] The workman melteth a graven image, and the goldsmith spreadeth it over with gold, and casteth silver chains. [20] He that is so impoverished that he hath no oblation chooseth a tree that will not rot; he seeketh unto him a cunning workman to prepare a graven image, that shall not be moved. [21] Have ye not known? have ye not heard? hath it not been told you from the beginning? have ye not understood from the foundations of the earth? [22] It is he that sitteth upon the circle of the earth, and the inhabitants thereof are as grasshoppers; that stretcheth out the heavens as a curtain, and spreadeth them out as a tent to dwell in: [23] That bringeth the princes to nothing; he maketh the judges of the earth as vanity. [24] Yea, they shall not be planted; yea, they shall not be sown: yea, their stock shall not take root in the earth: and he shall also blow upon them, and they shall wither, and the whirlwind shall take them away as stubble. [25] To whom then will ye liken me, or shall I be equal? saith the Holy One. [26] Lift up your eyes on high, and behold who hath created these things, that bringeth out their host by number: he calleth them all by names by the greatness of his might, for that he is strong in power; not one faileth. [27] Why sayest thou, O Jacob, and speakest, O Israel, My way is hid from the LORD, and my judgment is passed over from my God? [28] Hast thou not known? hast thou not heard, that the everlasting God, the LORD, the Creator of the ends of the earth, fainteth not, neither is weary? there is no searching of his understanding. [29] He giveth power to the faint; and to them that have no might he increaseth strength. [30] Even the youths shall faint and be weary, and the young men shall utterly fall: [31] But they that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint.

God's hand saving the Israelites is described as bearing them on eagles' wings

Exodus 19:4

Ye have seen what I did unto the Egyptians, and how I bare you on eagles' wings, and brought you unto myself.

Those who do not seek the counsel of God are described as “rebellious children”

Isaiah 30:1

Woe to the rebellious children, saith the LORD, that take counsel, but not of me; and that cover with a covering, but not of my spirit, that they may add sin to sin:

Quietness of spirit and confidence in God is our strength.

Isaiah 30:15-16

For thus saith the Lord GOD, the Holy One of Israel; In returning and rest shall ye be saved; in quietness and in confidence shall be your strength: and ye would not. [16] But ye said, No; for we will flee upon horses; therefore shall ye flee: and, We will ride upon the swift; therefore shall they that pursue you be swift.

Egypt is a typology of our life before being saved. It can also represent the world or the wisdom of the world.

Isaiah 31:1

Woe to them that go down to Egypt for help; and stay on horses, and trust in chariots, because they are many; and in horsemen, because they are very strong; but they look not unto the Holy One of Israel, neither seek the LORD!

Trusting in the world, the wisdom of it, or the wisdom from ourselves is a bad idea. Additionally, the book of proverbs is full of warnings against not seeking the wisdom that is from above.

I Corinthians 3:19

For the wisdom of this world is foolishness with God. For it is written, He taketh the wise in their own craftiness.

I Corinthians 2:6

Howbeit we speak wisdom among them that are perfect: yet not the wisdom of this world, nor of the princes of this world, that come to nought:

Proverbs 3:5,6

Trust in the Lord with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. [6] In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.

Waiting on the Lord implies that we are expecting something from Him. We can expect God to do what He said He would, which we can learn about in scripture, and if we pray as scripture tells us to we can also expect Him to answer that prayer.

What does waiting on God look like?

Hebrews 4:9-11

There remaineth therefore a rest to the people of God. [10] For he that is entered into his rest, he also hath ceased from his own works, as God did from his. [11] Let us labour therefore to enter into that rest, lest any man fall after the same example of unbelief^(Hebrews 3).

If we are expecting something from God (whether through prayer or a promise) and we cease our own works (stop moving, acting or speaking) only then are we waiting on Him.

It is in that waiting that we are told by [Isaiah 40:31](#) that the following will happen:

[Isaiah 40:31](#)

But they that wait upon the LORD shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles; they shall run, and not be weary; and they shall walk, and not faint.

1. Renewed strength
 - Physical from not exerting our own efforts
 - Spiritual from the experience of drawing closer to God and putting our trust in Him
2. Mount up with wings as eagles
 - Literal
 - God's hand will carry us and guide us, as it did the Israelites out of Egypt ([Exodus 19:4](#))
 - Figuratively
 - We'll soar high above the world, our circumstances, and our problems. Our confidence in God and His provision supplants all manner of evil such as worry, doubt, fear, anxiety, and more.
3. Run and not be weary
 - [Hebrews 12:1,2](#)
 - We won't grow weary (tired) in the spiritual marathon ("run with patience") set before us
 - A life for Christ after being reborn is ideally a life of pursuing spiritual maturity as opposed to the "old creature" ([II Corinthians 5:17](#)) which pursued fleshy desires and was a servant of sin ([Romans 6:17,18](#)). Note that this is a choice – Christ gives us the freedom and ability ("set free") to serve Him instead of sin but we still have to choose.
4. Walk and not faint
 - Our walk is our life and to faint is to be disheartened, lose heart, to be feeble (weak), depressed or discouraged.

More verses about waiting on the Lord.

Psalm 27:14

Wait on the Lord: be of good courage, and he shall strengthen thine heart: wait, I say, on the Lord.

Psalm 37:7

Rest in the Lord, and wait patiently for him: fret not thyself because of him who prospereth in his way, because of the man who bringeth wicked devices to pass.

Proverbs 20:22

Say not thou, I will recompense evil; but wait on the Lord, and he shall save thee.

Isaiah 30:18

And therefore will the Lord wait, that he may be gracious unto you, and therefore will he be exalted, that he may have mercy upon you: for the Lord is a God of judgment: blessed are all they that wait for him.

Isaiah 49:23

And kings shall be thy nursing fathers, and their queens thy nursing mothers: they shall bow down to thee with their face toward the earth, and lick up the dust of thy feet; and thou shalt know that I am the LORD: for they shall not be ashamed that wait for me.

Lamentations 3:25,26

The Lord is good unto them that wait for him, to the soul that seeketh him. [26] It is good that a man should both hope and quietly wait for the salvation of the Lord.

Hosea 12:6

Therefore turn thou to thy God: keep mercy and judgment, and wait on thy God continually.